



Fight to the finish: Tanvi lost to Thailand's Anyapat Phichitpreechasak in the final. RITU RAJ KONWAR

rounds, which featured several one-sided contests, saw some matches finish in as little as ten minutes. Overall, only seven fixtures lasted between 50 and 60 minutes, while three crossed the hour mark — the longest being a girls' doubles quarterfinal that stretched to one hour and 18 minutes. The shorter duration reduced physical strain on the players.

The BWF will gather data from further trials before deciding at its Annual General Meeting in April 2026 whether to implement the format across all levels.

Of India's 18 entries across five categories, five reached the quarterfinals — Bhargav-Viswa (boys' doubles), Bhavya

Chhabra-Vishakha Toppo (mixed doubles), Tankara Gnana Dattu Talasila (boys' singles), Tanvi and Unnati (girls' singles) — but only Tanvi progressed beyond that stage.

The runs of Andhra duo Bhargav and Viswa (playing together since the age of 13) and Bhavya and Vishakha, who paired up for the first time in an international event, show how the next generation of Indians are taking doubles more seriously under Sozonov's guidance. The success of the country's top men's pair, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty, has clearly inspired the next generation.

Top seed Tanvi, who idolises former World No. 1 Tai Tzu Ying of Chinese Taipei for her strokeplay and

deception, was at her fluent best in a 15-11, 15-9 semifinal win over China's Liu Si Ya. However, Thailand's Anyapat Phichitpreechasak — who had earlier beaten Unnati in the quarterfinals — denied Tanvi the chance to become only the second Indian gold medallist after Saina Nehwal (2008), prevailing 15-7, 15-12 in the final. The 16-year-old from Hoshiarpur later admitted she needed to sharpen her strokes and build greater endurance and patience.

Guided by former Olympic and World Champion Chen Long, China's Liu Yang Ming Yu defeated top-seeded Indonesian Mohd Zaki Ubaidillah 15-10, 15-11 to claim the boys' singles crown. China also won